Best Practice

Initial Risk Classification

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Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location

☐ Global Business Services Barcelona

☒ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil

☐ Global Business Services Manila

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☐ Global Business Services Bangalore

☒ Global Business Services Dalian

☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country

☒ Global
☐ Specific Country:

Relevance for R&D QMS

☐ Affected
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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

This Best Practice gives direction for the initial processing and assessment of complaint data in the global complaint database by defining Initial Risk Categories. The Best Practice refers to different product types/routes of administration, as well as some specific product groups.

However, this Best Practice does not cover all products.

It operates as a supplement to the general Global Business Services process SOP: SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

In scope are the following topics/ routes of administration:

- caplets, tablets, effervescent tablets, capsules, granular, powders, gummies, dragees
- soft gels, liquid gels, ointments, creams, lotions, solutions, shampoo
- aerosols, pump sprays
- biologics
- radiology products (for contrast media, error codes for devices are under responsibility of RQU)
- product groups: oral contraceptives, HydraSense, Betaseron System, Betaject lite system and Midol Heat vibes.

The entry of data into the global complaint database is performed by Global Business Services Staff

1.2 Framework

The content of this Best Practice is coming from Best Practices of the US Country Quality Management System. Not all global products are covered here.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CQU	Country Quality Unit
LODE	Lack of drug effect
LOE	Lack of effect
ME	Medical Event
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
GBS	Global Business Services
UI	Usability Issue

3 Definitions

Counterfeit incidents Counterfeit covers:

- Trademark Violation: Product either using without authorization any or a combination of the following: tradename, trademark, icon, rights owned and protected by Bayer according to applicable legislation.

- Fraudulent products: “Products imitating a “generic” version of a genuine (Bayer) product by using any or a combination of the following (1) visual aspects of the original, (2) naming very close to

the original or (3) claiming that the same API is present and independent of its registration status and true composition by excluding generic products with known legal registration status which belong to an identifiable MAH."

Counterfeit products (Falsifications):

Falsification cover:

- Any medicinal product with a false representation of its identity, including its packaging and labelling, its name or its composition (other than any unintentional quality defect) as regards any of its ingredients including excipients and the strength of those ingredients

- Manipulations of genuine product for instance but not limited to (1) changing variable data, (2) removing/exchanging content, (3) returned and resold used products

- Disappeared/Diverted Product: Genuine product rerouted out of its intended legal supply chain into another supply chain by unauthorized actions, irrespective of whether the second supply chain is legal or not

- Disappeared/Theft/Stolen Product: Genuine product taken without authorization from anywhere in the upstream or downstream supply chain (warehouse, transport means, whilst within transit), be it by use of force, threat of force (e.g., robbery), misappropriation (e.g., by personnel) or deception (e.g., fraud)

Initial risk classification:

Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents are classified by RQU after receipt. However, for cases that fulfil the requirements for local closure, GBS must assign the initial risk classification. The classification is based on the company's assessment of the nature of the case and the potential risk to patient/ customer/ user/ environment safety.

High: Complaints regarding potential defects which are potentially life-threatening or could cause a serious risk to health.

Medium: Complaints regarding potential defects which could cause illness or mistreatment with potentially non-serious medical consequences but are not classified as high.

Low: Complaints regarding potential defects which may not pose a significant hazard to health.

Lack of Drug Effect (LODE)/ Lack of Effect (LOE):

Failure to produce the expected physiological/ pharmacological action. The term LODE is synonym to the term Lack of Effect (LOE), with LODE referring to drug substances and LOE referring to medical devices.

Product Technical Complaint (PTC):	A Product Technical Complaint (PTC) is any report received (written, electronic or verbal communication) about a potential or alleged failure of a product in its quality [including the identity, durability, reliability, safety, effectiveness (safety and effectiveness are device related) or performance] or a suspected counterfeit. The product technical complaint may or may not represent a potential risk to patient/ customer/ user/ environment.
Pharmacovigilance (PV) Case:	Report which qualifies for capturing in the PV safety database. This includes reports of suspected adverse (drug) reactions (also referred to as individual case safety report (ICSR), adverse events, invalid cases, medical device reports, serious undesirable effect (SUE) for cosmetic products and certain reports without adverse event referring to: special circumstances (e.g. exposure via parent, lack of drug effect (LODE), medication errors, (intentional) product use issue, off-label use, pre-existing condition improved (in an unapproved indication) and occupational exposure.
Usability Issue:	Use error or customer satisfaction issue of a medical device or the medical device constituent of a combination product are each a subgroup of usability issues. Use error: Act or omission of an act, that has a different result to that intended by the manufacturer or expected by the operator of the medical device or the medical device constituent of a combination product. Use error includes slips, lapses and mistakes. An unexpected physiological response of the subject does not in itself constitute as a use error Customer satisfaction issue: An expression of dissatisfaction by a customer/user, regarding a medical device or the medical device constituent of a combination product because there is no allegation that product fails to meet claims. Customer satisfaction issues include, e.g., handling problems, difficulties to understand or to follow the instructions, etc.

4 Purpose & Process

This Best Practice provides guidance on the processing of data on Product Technical Complaints in the global complaint database by defining different complaint types and their associated variables like:

- IQMS level-1, level-2, level-3
- initial risk classification

4.1 General Guidance

The chapter/ subchapters of this document present tables with each column stating an important variable for entering complaint data into the global complaint database. Each subchapter refers to a different product type, route of administration or specific product groups.

Chapter 5.1 discusses solid forms of administration including:

- Caplets, tablets, effervescent tablets, as well as oral contraceptives in specific
- Granules and powders
- Capsules (including soft gels and liquid gels)
- Gummies and dragees

Chapter 5.2 refers to semi solids, liquids and aerosols including:

- Solutions, suspensions and shampoos
- Ointments, balms, creams, lotions and gels
- Aerosols and pump sprays (e.g. nasal sprays)
- HydraSense

Chapter 5.3 states details for transdermal products

Chapter 5.4 specifies variables for Parenterals, as biologics in general or the Betaseron product.

Chapters 5.5 and 5.6 refer to Radiology products, as well as Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve stimulation systems (TENS).

Chapter 5.6. Specifies the error codes applicable to the product Midol Heat Vibes

The tables can perform as guidance for this process in two possible ways:

- The subchapter referring to the respective complaint product is picked. The row of the exact complaint reason describes the variables which are entered into the database.
- Needed information can be found by using the search function of the document.

4.2 Assigned Roles and Responsibilities

For this document, the rules and responsibilities described in SOP SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS” applied accordingly.

5 Product-group related specifics on entering Product Technical Complaints into Data base.

5.1 Solids

5.1.1 Caplets, tablets and effervescent

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken/ crushed tablets	effervescent tablets, tablets	damage	breakage	Low
broken cap	sealing cap	damage	breakage	Low
capping	tablets	damage	breakage	Low
coating	tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	coating	Low
commingling of Product	blister, bottle, folding box, pouch, tablet	other	mix up of batches/ product	High
consistency	effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
damaged blister (not attributed to shipping)	blister	damage	breakage or perforation	Low
deformation	effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation	Low
difficulty dispensing tablet from blister or pouch	blister, pouch	handling	handling difficult or impossible	Low
difficulty handling sealing cap	sealing cap	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
difficulty sliding blister	blister	handling	handling difficult or impossible	Low
discoloration	effervescent tablets, tablets	Appearance/ Product Characteristics	discoloration	Low
disintegration issue	tablets	Appearance/ Product Characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
empty carton	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
empty pouch/blister/ bottle	blister, bottle, pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
finished package incomplete (parts missing)	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in product/ packaging (product contact)	blister, bottle, effervescent tablets, pouch, tablets	contamination/ foreign matter	**	High
foreign substance in packaging (no product contact)	folding box, pouch	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Low
imprint/l labelling information - missing	blister, bottle, folding box, pouch, tablet	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
imprint/l labelling information - illegible	blister, bottle, folding box, pouch, tablet	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
label adhesiveness	label	appearance/ product characteristics	adhesion/adhesiveness	Low
label missing	bottle, folding box	print/ labelling	label missing	High
lot number/ expiration date - missing	bottle, blister, pouch, label or folding box	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	bottle, blister, pouch, label or folding box	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low

missing bottle or blister	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
misplaced tablet (if intact)	blister	other	mix up of batches/ product	High
missing tablets (packaging/ foil intact)	blister, bottle, pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
missing tablets (packaging/ foil not intact)	blister, bottle, pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
mold in product	blister, bottle, effervescent tablets, pouch, tablets	contamination/ foreign matter	other	High
no fizz	effervescent tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	solubility	Low
odor complaint	bottle, effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low
overfill	bottle, pouch	quantity	overfilling in immediate container	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	bottle, blister, pouch or folding box	damage	immediate container	Low
sharp seal	sealing cap	appearance/ product characteristics	other	Low
spots	effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	spots, changed or heterogeneous appearance	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tablets crumble	effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
tablets stuck together	effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	agglutination	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing	sealing cap	damage	originally seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged	sealing cap	damage	originality seal missing	Low
tamper/ induction seal issue-inside foil - damaged	bottle	damage	originally seal damaged	Low
tamper/ induction seal issue-inside foil - missing	bottle	damage	originality seal missing	Low
unusual flavor	effervescent tablets, tablets	appearance/ product characteristics	taste/flavor	Low

5.1.2 Specific: Oral Contraceptives or Hormonal Replacement Therapy

Complaint Type	Product complaint reason	IQMS Error Code Level-1	IQMS Error Code Level-2	IQMS Error Code Level-3	Initial risk Classification	Additional information
defect of drug product	wrong tablet/dragee (incl. Phase-mix-up)	tablet, dragee/ coated tablet	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medim	example: mix-up of products in containers
defect of drug product	missing tablet/ dragee	tablet, dragee/ coated tablet	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low	
defect of drug product	tablet/ Dragee damage	tablet, dragee/ coated tablet	damage	breakage	Low	broken tablets, fragments (including breakage at removal from blister)
defect of drug product	tablet/ Dragee discoloration	tablet, dragee/ coated tablet	appearance/ product characteristics	Discoloration: spots, changed or heterogeneous appearance	Low	any sort of discoloration/ heterogeneous appearance
defect of drug product	tablet/ Dragee surface defect	tablet, dragee/ coated tablet	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation; coating	Low	deviations in surface condition/consistency coating errors poor embossing/print depending on magnitude might also be class IV)
defect of drug product	contamination (product contact)	tablet, dragee/ coated tablet	contamination/foreign matter	various subcodes possible e.g. embedding of an insect; fiber; hair; particles; other /not specified	Low	contamination: e.g. microbial spoilage. Dirt or detritus, particulate matter although biological contamination might be locally assessed as critical, it is in general not seen as a risk for patient safety in an oral product
defects of primary packaging	blister defect (e.g. one or more cavities open)	blister	damage	open, leakage/ Not tightly closed	Medium	stability of product might not be given, especially problematic climatic zone IV and in case of ACLAR blisters in case product is only marketed in climatic zone II and standard PVC blister is use, category III might be acceptable
defects of primary packaging	blister foil separation	foil	damage	other	Medium	although cavities are closed, transparent foil layers are delaminating/separating, stability might not

						be given in case ACLAR layer is peeling off
defects of primary packaging	blister/ foil defect affecting drug product	foil	sealing failure	other	Low	blister foil is sealed to tablet, individual cases
defects of primary packaging	blister/ foil defect not affecting drug product (cavities intact)	blister	appearance/ product characteristics damage	other, deformation	Low	protection of drug product against air/ moisture ingress still given
defects of primary packaging	contamination (product contact)	blister	contamination/ foreign matter	other, not specified	Low	contamination of blister foil (inner side) although biological contamination might be locally assessed as critical, it is in general not seen as a risk for patient safety in an oral product
defects of primary packaging	contamination of blister (no drug product contact)	blister	contamination/ foreign matter; appearance/ product characteristics	finished package incomplete (parts missing); other	Low	quantity of blisters in folding box too high or too low
defects from print/labelling of primary packaging	Imprint/ Variable data illegible/ missing	blister	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data	Low	e.g. batch number or expiration dates missing/ wrong/ incomplete/ illegible or hard to see cave: expiry date! Expiry data exceeding shelf life or missing completely is category II!
defects from print/labelling of primary packaging	intake scheme not at correct position/ illegible	blister	print/ labelling	other	Medium	to be categorized as II in case imprint might lead to wrong intake if clear assignment of phases is possible, category III might be used
defects of functional secondary packaging: pouches, wallets	pouch/ bag defect (tightness not given)	pouch	damage	leakage/ not tightly closed, perforation	Medium	pouch is protective packaging stability of product might not be given, especially in climatic zone IV b **pouch:** aluminum bag used for stability enhancement, especially in climatic

						zones Iva/b (e.g. Femovan, Meliane) **wallet:** blister is glued into carton packaging, which is subsequently folded to a wallet configuration (e.g. Yaz or Qlaira) Wallets are wrapped up with foil (single pack or bundle) Wallet is not an object type in Dev @ com, use "blister" as object type and describe wallet error under short description)
defects of functional secondary packaging: pouches, wallets	pouch/ bag defect (but tightly closed	pouch	appearance/ product characteristics damage	other, deformation	Low	cosmetic defect
defects of functional secondary packaging: pouches, wallets	missing calendar	blister	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing); other	Low	intake scheme clear but calendar not included in wallet card
defects of functional secondary packaging: pouches, wallets	cosmetic defect	blister	damage	other	Low	no hazard to patient's health e.g. adhesive calendar glued in wrong place blister not glue correctly in wallet card poor quality shrink-wrap of wallet
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	expiry data exceeding shelf life or missing completely	folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing error of imprint/ labelling data; imprint/ labelling data illegible; error of variable data	Low	e.g. batch number missing, imprints/ embossing are incomplete/ illegible or hard to see also valid for printed "D Matrix codes if required by authority cave: expiry date!
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	serial number incomplete	bundle, pack, folding box	print/ labelling	Error of variable data	Low	no hazard to patient's health

imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	wrong language/ label/ missing or misleading information on patient information leaflet	bundle, folding box, label, pack, package insert, pouch	print/ labelling	finished package incomplete (parts missing); leaflet wrong; label wrong; Label missing	Medium	mislabeling (e.g. wrong or missing text or figures) missing or incorrect information (leaflets or inserts) missing or wrong patient information leaflet is especially critical in case of complex intake scheme/ hormonal products with >1 phase
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	anti-counterfeiting security features not correct or missing; missing or damaged originality seal	bundle, folding box, pack	print/ labelling damage	other, originality seal missing, originality seal damaged	Medium	production issues (e.g. missing coin reactive ink) cave: for suspected counterfeit or product diversion, see GSOP 115
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	missing or incorrect label (registered logistical information)	folding box, label	print/ labelling	finished package incomplete (parts missing), label wrong, label missing	Low	e.g. missing 2D matrix code label if required by authority
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	cosmetic defect (calendar, folding box, patient information leaflet, pack, bundle)	bundle, folding box, pack, package insert, pouch	appearance/ product characteristics damage	spots, changed or heterogeneous appearance, deformation, breakage; open; other	Low	no hazard to patient's health, e.g. secondary materials, damaged or cracked labels partly detached, spots or stains on outer packaging
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	missing envelope; Missing label (internal logistic information)	folding box, label	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing), label wrong, label missing	Low	no hazard to patient's health; e.g. separate carton envelope for blister is not included, missing logistic label
imprint/ embossing of variable data/ package imprints (secondary packaging)	missing packs in shipping container	pack, shipping/ carton box	quantity	final product missing in shipping container	Low	no hazard to patient's health

5.1.3 Granules and Powders

Product complaint reason	IQMS Level-1	IQMS Level-2	IQMS Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken cap	sealing cap	damage	breakage	Low
commingling of product	bottle, folding box	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
consistency	powder	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
difficulty handling sealing cap	sealing cap	handling	handling difficult/ impossible	Low
discoloration	powder	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low
does not dissolve	powder	appearance/ product characteristics	solubility	Low
empty carton	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
error of imprint/ labelling data	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
finished package incomplete (parts missing)	bottle, folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in product (product contact)	powder	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on description	Medium
foreign substance in packaging (no product contact)	folding box	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on description	Low
imprint/ labelling information - illegible	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
imprint/ labelling information - missing	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
label missing	bottle, folding box	labelling	label missing	High
leakage	bottle	leakage	location unknown/ other	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil intact)	bottle, pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil not intact)	bottle, pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
mold in product	powder	contamination/ foreign matter	other	Medium
odor complaint	powder	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	bottle, folding box, pouch	damage	immediate container	Low
suspected counterfeit	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium

tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged	sealing cap	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing	sealing cap	damage	originality seal missing	Low
tamper/ induction seal issue - inside foil - damaged	bottle	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper/ induction seal issue - inside foil - missing	bottle	damage	originality seal missing	Low
unusual taste/ flavor	powder	appearance/ product characteristics	taste/ flavor	Low

5.1.4 Capsules, Soft Gels and Liquid Gels

Product complaint reason	IQMS Error Code Level-1	IQMS Error Code Level-1	IQMS Error Code Level-1	Initial risk Classification
blooming (powdery substance on capsule in blister)	capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	coating	Low
broken (glass) bottle	bottle	damage	breakage	Low
broken cap	sealing cap	damage	breakage	Low
broken/crushed capsules	capsule	damage	breakage	Low
capsules stuck together/ melted	capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	agglutination	Low
commingling of product	blister, bottle, capsule, folding box	other	mix up of batches/ product	Low
consistency	capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
deformation	capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation	Low
difficulty dispensing - blister	blister	handling	handling difficult or	Low
difficulty handling sealing cap	sealing cap	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
difficulty sliding blister	blister	capsule	handling difficult or impossible	Low
discoloration	capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low
empty carton	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
error of imprint/ labeling data	blister, bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
finished package incomplete (parts missing)	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in packaging (no product contact)	blister, folding box	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Low
foreign substance in packaging (product contact)	blister, bottle, capsule	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Medium
imprint/ labeling information - missing	blister, bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
imprint/ labeling information - illegible	blister, bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
label missing	bottle, folding box	print/ labelling	label missing	Medium
leakage	capsule	damage	breakage	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	blister, bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low

lot number/ expiration date - missing	blister, bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil intact)	blister, bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil not intact)	blister, bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
misplaced capsule (if intact)	blister	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
mold in product	capsule	contamination/ foreign matter	other	Medium
odor complaint	bottle, capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	other	Low
overfill	bottle	quantity	overfilling in immediate container	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	blister, bottle, folding box	damage	immediate container	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged	sealing cap	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing	sealing cap	damage	originality seal misusing	Low
tamper/induction seal issue - damaged	bottle	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper/induction seal issue - missing	bottle	damage	originality seal missing	Low
unusual flavor	capsule	appearance/ product characteristics	taste/ flavor	Low
Adverse Event, LODE	capsule	medical event	Adverse Event no or reduced efficacy	**

5.1.5 Gummies and Dragees

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classifi
air released upon opening	sealing cap	damage	inflated/ puffing	Low
broken cap	sealing cap	damage	breakage	Low
broken/ crushed dragee	dragee	damage	breakage	Low
commingling of product	bottle, dragee or gummies	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
consistency (not including hardness)	dragee or gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
cracked shell	dragee	damage	breakage	Low
difficulty handling twist & lock cap	sealing cap	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
discoloration	dragee or gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low
foreign substance in bottle	bottle	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on description	Medium
foreign substance in product	dragee or gummies	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on description	Medium
gummies stuck together/melted	gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	agglutination	Low
hardness	dragee or gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low

imprint labelling information - missing	label	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
imprint labelling information - smudged	label	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing (packaging)	bottle	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
lot number/ expiration date - smudged (packaging)	bottle	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil not intact)	bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil intact)	bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
missing labelling - bottle	bottle	print/ labelling	label missing	Low
mold in product	dragees or gummies	contamination/ foreign matter	other	Medium
odor complaint	bottle, dragee or gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	bottle	damage	immediate container	Low
size - different than usual	dragees or gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversions	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tamper/ induction seal issue - inside foil - damaged	bottle	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper/ induction seal issue - inside foil - missing	bottle	damage	originality seal missing	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged	sealing cap	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing	sealing cap	damage	originality seal missing	Low
unusual flavor	dragee or gummies	appearance/ product characteristics	taste/ flavor	Low

5.2 Semi-solids, liquids and aerosols

5.2.1 Solutions, suspensions and shampoos

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken cap	sealing cap	sealing cap	breakage	Low
broken/ damaged bottle	bottle	bottle	breakage	Low
consistency	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	consistency/ hardness	Low
commingling of product	solution/ suspension/ shampoo bottle, folding box	bottle, folding box solution/ suspension/ shampoo	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
difficulty handling sealing cap	sealing cap	sealing cap	handling difficult/ impossible	Low
discoloration	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	discoloration	Low

empty carton	folding box	folding box	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	low
error of imprint/ labelling data	bottle, label, folding box	bottle, folding box, label	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
finished package incomplete	folding box	folding box	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in product (product contact)	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	**	Medium
foreign substance in product (no product contact)	folding box	folding box	**	Low
imprint labelling information - missing	bottle, label, folding box	bottle, folding box, label	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
imprint labelling information - illegible	bottle, label, folding box	bottle, folding box, label	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
label missing	bottle, folding box	bottle, folding box	label missing	Medium (CH) Low (PH)
leakage	bottle, sealing cap, spray nozzle	leakage	location unknown/ other	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing	bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil intact)	bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
low fill (packaging/ foil not intact)	bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
odor complaint	solution/ suspension/ shampoo	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	bottle	damage	immediate container	Low
suspected counterfeit	bottle	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	bottle	diversion	smuggling, theft	Medium
suspected tampering	bottle	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tamper/induction seal issue - foil seal - damaged	bottle	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper/induction seal issue - foil seal - missing	bottle	damage	originality seal missing	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged	article	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing	article	damage	originality seal missing	Low
unusual taste	solution, suspension	appearance/ product characteristics	taste/ flavor	Low

5.2.2 Ointments, balms creams, lotions and gels

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken cap	sealing cap	damage	breakage	Low
broken/ split at the seam tube or bottle	bottle, tube	damage	breakage	Low
commingling of product	applicator, balm, bottle, cream, folding box, gel, lotion, ointment, gel	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
consistency	balm, cream, gel, lotion, ointment	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
damaged/ broken balm	balm	damage	formulated product	Low
discolouration	balm, cream, gel, lotion, ointment	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low
empty carton	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
error of imprint/ labelling data	applicator, bottle, folding box, label, tube	print/ labelling	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
finished package incomplete (parts missing)	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in packaging (no product contact)	balm, cream, gel, lotion, ointment	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on description	Low
foreign substance in product (product contact)	balm, cream, gel, lotion, ointment	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on description	Medium
imprint/ labelling information - illegible	applicator, bottle, folding box, label, tube	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
imprint/ labelling information - missing	applicator, bottle, folding box, label, tube	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
label missing	applicator, bottle, folding box, tube	print/ labelling	label missing	Medium (CH) Low(PH)
leakage	bottle, tube	leakage	location unknown/ other	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	applicator, bottle, folding box, label, tube	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing	applicator, bottle, folding box, label, tube	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill (packaging not intact)	applicator, bottle, tube	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
low fill (packaging intact)	applicator, bottle, tube	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
odor complaint	balm, cream, gel, lotion, ointment	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	applicator, bottle, folding box, tube	damage	immediate container	Low

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
product release incomplete/ impossible	applicator	malfunction	product release incomplete/ impossible	Low
product release uncontrolled	applicator	malfunction	product release uncontrolled	Low
residue on skin	cream, lotion	appearance/ product characteristics	leaves residue on skin	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tamper/induction seal issue - inside foil - damaged	bottle, tube	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper/induction seal issue - inside foil - missing	bottle, tube	damage	originality seal missing	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged	sealing cap	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing	sealing cap	damage	originality seal missing	Low

** depends on specific complaint description

5.2.3 Aerosols and pump sprays (including Nasal Sprays)

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken cap	sealing cap	damage	breakage	Low
broken nozzle **OR** pump	spray nozzle	damage	breakage	Low
commingling of product	bottle, folding box	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
consistency	foam, solution	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
difficulty handling sealing cap	sealing cap	handling	handling difficult or impossible	Low
discoloration	foam, solution	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low
does not dispense properly	spray nozzle	malfunction	product release uncontrolled	Low
does not spray	spray nozzle	malfunction	no spray	Low
empty carton	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
error of imprint/ labelling data	bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
finished package incomplete (parts missing)	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in product	foam, solution	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Medium
foreign substance in packaging (no product contact)	folding box	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Low

imprint/ labelling information - illegible	bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
imprint/ labelling information - missing	bottle, folding box, label	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
leakage	bottle, sealing cap, spray nozzle	leakage	location unknown/ other	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	bottle, label, folding box	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing	bottle, label, folding box	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill	bottle	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
label missing	bottle, folding box	print/ labelling	label missing	Medium(CH) Low (PH)
odor complaint	foam, solution	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low)
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	bottle, folding box	damage	immediate container	Low
residue on skin	foam, spray	appearance/ product characteristics	leaves residue on skin	Low
stops spraying	spray nozzle	malfunction	product release impossible/ incomplete	Low
suspected counterfeit	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tamper seal issue - neckband - damaged (excludes aerosol sunscreens)	sealing cap	damage	originality seal damaged	Low
tamper seal issue - neckband - missing (excludes aerosol sunscreens)	sealing cap	damage	originality seal missing	Low
adverse event LODE	foam, solution	medical event	adverse event no or reduced efficacy	**

5.2.4 Specific: HydraSense product line

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
bottle rounded on the bottom	bottle	damage	other	Low
cannot open salt packets	pouch	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
cannot open vials	phial	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
consistency	powder, solution	appearance/ product characteristics	consistency/ hardness	Low
components cannot be assembled after cleaning won't fit together	multi-component assembly	handling issue	assembly activation	Low
difficulties adjusting the intensity of the flow	spray nozzle	malfunction	mechanical problem	Low

difficulty handling spray nozzle	spray nozzle	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
difficulties putting the tube for squeeze mode (dual cleanse kit)	multi-component assembly	handling issue	assembly/ activation	Low
discoloration	powder, solution	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low
does not spray	spray	malfunction	no spray	Low
error of imprint/ labelling data	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
finished package incomplete (parts missing)	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in product (product contact)	bottle, pouch, powder	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Medium
foreign substance in package (no product contact)	folding box	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Low
imprint/ labelling information - illegible	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
imprint/ labelling information - missing	bottle, folding box, label, pouch	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low
issues with the bottle threads	bottle	damage	other	Low
leakage	bottle, spray nozzle	leakage	location unknown/other	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	folding box, pouch, label	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing	folding box, pouch, label	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
low fill	bottle, phial, pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
missing insert	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Medium
missing label	bottle, pouch, folding box	labelling	label missing	Medium
mix up of products/ batches	bottle, folding box, pouch, powder, solution, phial	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
mold in product	bottle, folding box, pouch, powder, solution, phial	contamination/ foreign matter	other/ not specified	Medium
moisture in salt packages	pouch	appearance/ product characteristics	other	Low
mucus went past filter	multi-component assembly	handling issue	assembly/ activation	Low
odor	powder, solution, bottle, pouch	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	bottle, blister, pouch, folding box	damage	immediate container	Low
solubility	powder	appearance/ product characteristics	solubility	Low
sprays too fast	spray nozzle	malfunction	product release uncontrolled	Low
stops spraying	spray nozzle	malfunction	product release impossible/ incomplete	Low
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected counterfeit	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
tamper seal issue - damage	folding box	damage	originality seal damage	Low

tamper seal issue - missing	folding box	damage	originality seal missing	Low
varying levels of liquids in single-use vials	phial	quantity	other	Low
adverse event LODE	powder, solution	medical event	adverse event no or reduced efficacy	**
Hard to squeeze	bottle	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
Hard to get drops out	bottle	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
Bottles too hard to squeeze	bottle	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
Bottles too soft to squeeze	bottle	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
Drops coming out from side	bottle	leakage	location unknown/ other	Low
Drops stop coming out part way through bottle	bottle	damage	other	Low
More than one drop dispensed when squeezing	bottle	damage	other	Low

**** depends on specific complaint description

5.3 Transdermal

5.3.1 Plasters and Patches

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
adhesive delamination	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	coating	Low
brittle patch	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	wrinkle/ crinkling/ dried out	Low
commingling of product	pouch, folding box, plaster/ patch	folding box, plaster/ patch, pouch	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
cut patch or pouch	plaster/ patch, pouch	plaster/ patch, pouch	other	Low
difficulty removing patch from pouch	pouch	pouch	handling difficult or impossible	Low
discoloration	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	discoloration	Low
empty carton	folding box	folding box	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
error of imprint/ labelling data	label, pouch, folding box	folding box, label, pouch	error of imprint/ labelling data	Low
excess adhesive perimeter	plaster/ pouch	plaster/ patch	patch/ glue leakage	Low
finished package incomplete	pouch, plaster/patch	pouch, plaster/patch	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
foreign substance in packaging (no product contact)	folding box	folding box	**	Low
foreign substance in packaging (product contact)	plaster, patch, pouch	plaster/ patch, pouch	**	Medium
imprint/ labelling information - missing	label, pouch, folding box	folding box, label, pouch	imprint/ labelling data missing	Low

imprint/ labelling information - illegible	label, pouch, folding box	folding box, label, pouch	imprint/ labelling data illegible	Low
label missing	folding box/ pouch	folding box, pouch	label missing	Medium
lack of adhesion	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	adhesion/adhesiveness	Low
liner cut unevenly	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	other	Low
liner difficult to remove from patch	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	handling difficult or impossible	Low
liner dislodged when patch removed from pouch	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	handling difficult or impossible	Low
liner not split	plaster/ patch	plaster/ patch	missing overlap tabs	Low
lot number/ expiration date - illegible	label, pouch, folding box	folding box, label, pouch	variable data illegible	Low
lot number/ expiration date - missing	label, pouch, folding box	folding box, label, pouch	variable data missing	Low
low fill (packaging not intact)	pouch, folding box	pouch, folding box	underfilling in immediate container	Low
low fill (packaging intact)	pouch, folding box	pouch, folding box	underfilling in immediate container	Low
odor complaint	plaster/patch, pouch	plaster/patch, pouch	odor	Low
open pouch	pouch	damage	open	Low
packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	folding box/ pouch	damage	immediate container	Low
patch appears thicker/thinner	plaster/patch	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation	Low
patch folded over on liner	plaster/patch	damage	other	Low
patch offset on liner	plaster/patch	damage	other	Low
suspected counterfeit	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling or theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
adverse event	plaster/patch	medical event	adverse event no or reduced efficacy	**

** depends on specific complaint description

5.3.2 3M drug delivery systems

Description **Document Reference**

US03REGS-BP000106

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification	batch record review	test required
adhesive delamination	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	coating	Low	mixing, coating, converting	adhesion, content
adhesive residue on clothing/ bedding	plaster/ patch	other	patch (glue leakage)	Low	none	adhesion
adhesive residue on skin	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	adhesion/ adhesiveness	Low	none	adhesion

aesthetic carton defect	folding box	damage	breakage	Low	packaging	visual
aesthetic patch defect	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	**	Low	converting	visual
aesthetic pouch defect	pouch	damage	breakage	Low	converting	visual
brittle patch	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	wrinkle/cringing/ dried out	Low	mixing, coating	visual
commingling of product	folding box	other	mix up of batches/ product	Low	converting, packaging	visual
cut patch	plaster/ patch	damage	other	Low	converting	visual
cut pouch	pouch	damage	other	Low	converting	visual
dark ring on patch	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low	none	adhesion
difficulty removing patch from pouch	pouch	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low	converting	adhesion
empty pouch	pouch	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low	converting	visual
excess adhesive perimeter	plaster/ patch	other	patch/ glue leakage	Low	none	adhesion
foreign object	**	contamination/ foreign matter	other/ not specified	Medium	mixing, coating, converting	visual
foreign product	**	contamination/ foreign matter	other/ not specified	Medium	converting, packaging	visual
GML crystals	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	crystals/ precipitate	Low	none	appearance
lack of adhesion	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	adhesion/ adhesiveness	Low	none	adhesion
liner appearance	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	**	Low	converting	visual
liner cut unevenly	plaster/ patch	damage	other	Low	converting	visual
liner difficult to remove from patch	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	divisibility	Low	converting	visual
liner dislodged when patch removed from pouch	plaster/ patch	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low	converting	visual
liner not split	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	missing overlap tabs	Low	converting	visual
liner only in pouch	pouch	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low	converting	visual
loose desiccant powder in pouch	pouch	damage	perforation	Low	converting	visual
missing adhesive on patch	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	adhesion/ adhesiveness	Low	mixing, coating	adhesion, content
missing carton	shipping/ carton box	quantity	final product missing in shipping container	Low	packaging	none

missing desiccant label	pouch	print/ labelling	label missing	Low	converting	visual
missing insert/ booklet	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low	packaging	none
missing liner or liner piece	pouch	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low	converting	visual
missing lot number/ expiration date	folding box, pouch	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low	converting	visual
missing or partial printing	folding box, pouch	print/ labelling	imprint/ labelling, data missing	Low	converting	visual
missing pouch	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low	packaging	none
more than one patch in a pouch	pouch	quantity	overfilling in immediate container	Low	converting	none
odor complaint	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	odor	Low	mixing, coating	residual solvents (possible content adhesion)
open pouch	pouch	damage	originality seal damaged	Low	converting	visual
partial patch present	plaster/ patch	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low	converting	visual
Patch appears thicker	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation	Low	none	content
patch appears thinner	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	deformation	Low	none	content
patch folded over on liner	plaster/ patch	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low	converting	visual
patch offset on liner	plaster/ patch	damage	other	Low	converting	visual
patch sticks to clothing/ bedding	plaster/ patch	other	patch (glue leakage)	Low	none	adhesion
patch stuck to inside of pouch	plaster/ patch	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low	converting	visual
patch stuck into pouch seal	pouch	damage	originality seal damaged	Low	converting	visual
print on patch	plaster/ patch	print/ labelling	**	Low	converting	visual
print on labelling	label	print/ labelling	**	Low	packaging	visual
print on pouch	pouch	print/ labelling	**	Low	converting	visual
red/ pink patch	plaster/ patch	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Low	converting (red splice)	visual
split desiccant	pouch	damage	perforation	Low	converting	visual
AE (excludes skin irritation)/ MER	plaster/ patch	medical event	adverse reaction	Low	**	**
lack of effectiveness	plaster/ patch	medical event	no or reduced efficacy	Low	mixing, coating, converting	adhesion, content
skin irritation	plaster/ patch	medical event	adverse reaction	Low	mixing, coating, converting	residual solvents
diverted product	article	diversion	smuggling	Medium	none	identity

suspected counterfeit	article	falsification	imitation	Medium	none	identity

****** depends on specific complaint description

5.4 Parenteral

Description	Document Reference
	US03REGS-BP000107

5.4.1 Biologics

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Category
Handling Issues in use of product	Betaferon System	Handling Issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
concealed damage (not attributed to shipping)	folding box	damage	**	Low
coring	rubber stopper	damage	breakage	Low
difficulty dispensing	component as defined in source documentation	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
empty vial	phial	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
foreign matter	phial	contamination/ foreign matter	**	Medium
leakage	phial, syringe, transfer device	leakage	**	Low
low fill	phial, syringe	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
missing components	component as defined in source documentation	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
missing label	label	print labelling	label missing	Low
missing labelling	package insert	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
missing lot number/ expiration date	component as defined in source documentation	print labelling	variable data missing	Medium
missing vial	phial	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
product appearance	powder, solution	appearance/ product characteristics	**	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	imitation	Medium
vial/ syringe/ transfer device broke during use	phial, syringe, transfer device	damage	breakage	Low
vial received broken	phial	damage	breakage	Low

** depends on specific complaint description

5.4.2 Specific: Betaseron

5.4.2.1 Betaseron Kit

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
active vial(s) received broken	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	active vial(s) received broken - Betaferon Kit	Low
appearance active	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	appearance active - Betaferon Kit	Low
appearance Mixject/ vial adapter	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	appearance Mixject/ vial adapter - Betaferon Kit	Low
appearance of diluent	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	appearance of diluent - Betaferon Kit	Low
concealed damage	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	concealed damage - Betaferon Kit	Low
empty vial	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	empty vial - Betaferon Kit	Low
foreign particles in product	phial	contamination/ foreign matter	depends on complaint description	Medium
foreign matter on component/ packaging	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	foreign matter on component/ packaging - Betaferon Kit	Low
handling difficult or impossible	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	handling difficult or impossible	Low
loose needle shield	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	loose needle shield - Betaferon Kit	Low
lot/ product mixed up	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	lot/ product mix up - Betaferon Kit	Medium
low fill diluent syringe	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	low fill diluent syringe - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing/ loose dust cap	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing/ loose dust cap - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing diluent syringe cap	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing diluent syringe cap - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing label	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing label - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing lot number/ expiration date	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing lot number/ expiration date - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing packaging component	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing packaging component - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing product component	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing product component - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing tamper seal	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing tamper seal - Betaferon Kit	Low
missing wipe	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	missing wipe - Betaferon Kit	Low
needle defective	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	needle defective - Betaferon Kit	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	Imitation	Medium
suspected diversion	article	diversion	smuggling, theft	Medium
suspected tampering	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
syringe label defect	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	syringe label defect - Betaferon Kit	Low
syringe leak in packaging	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	syringe leak in packaging - Betaferon Kit	Low
syringe received broken	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	syringe received broken - Betaferon	Low
vial seal issue	Betaferon System	Betaferon Kit	vial seal issue - Betaferon Kit	Low

5.4.2.2 Betaseron assembly

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
active vial broke during use	Betaferon System	System Assembly	active vial broke during use - System Assembly	Low
difficulty inserting vial adapter	Betaferon System	System Assembly	difficulty inserting vial adapter - System Assembly	Low
difficulty removing dust cap	Betaferon System	System Assembly	difficulty removing dust cap - System Assembly	Low
difficulty with syringe rubber cap	Betaferon System	System Assembly	difficulty removing syringe rubber cap - System Assembly	Low
difficulty with syringe luerlock	Betaferon System	System Assembly	difficulty with syringe luerlock - System Assembly	Low
leak from syringe or connection	Betaferon System	System Assembly	leak from syringe or connection - System Assembly	Low
leak source unidentified	Betaferon System	System Assembly	leak source unidentified - System Assembly	Low
Mixject/ vial adapter problem	Betaferon System	System Assembly	Mixject/ vial adapter problem - System Assembly	Low
syringe breakage	Betaferon System	System Assembly	syringe breakage - System Assembly	Low
wipe issue	Betaferon System	System Assembly	wipe issue - System Assembly	Low

5.4.2.3 Betaseron reconstitution

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken syringe	Betaferon System	reconstitution	broken syringe - reconstitution	Low
difficulty depressing syringe plunger	Betaferon System	reconstitution	difficulty depressing syringe plunger - reconstitution	Low
difficulty withdrawing	Betaferon System	reconstitution	difficulty withdrawing - reconstitution	Low
foamy/ cloudy	Betaferon System	reconstitution	foamy/ cloudy - reconstitution	Low
leak between syringe and Mixject	Betaferon System	reconstitution	leak between syringe and Mixject - reconstitution	Low
leak between vial adapter cap and Betaseron stopper	Betaferon System	reconstitution	leak between vial adapter cap and Betaseron stopper - reconstitution	Low
leak from Mixject valve	Betaferon System	reconstitution	leak from Mixject valve - reconstitution	Low
leak source unidentified	Betaferon System	reconstitution	leak source unidentified - reconstitution	Low
Mixject/ vial adapter problem	Betaferon System	reconstitution	Mixject/ vial adapter problem - reconstitution	Low
undissolved particles/ dissolution incomplete	Betaferon System	reconstitution	undissolved particles/ dissolution incomplete - reconstitution	Low
repelling	Betaferon System	reconstitution	repelling - reconstitution	Medium

5.4.2.4 Betaseron injection

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
broken syringe barrel without injector	Betaferon System	injection	broken syringe barrel without injector - injection	Low
broken syringe barrel with injector	Betaferon System	injection	broken syringe barrel with injector	Low
broken syringe finger grips without injector	Betaferon System	injection	broken syringe finger grips without injector	Low
broken syringe finger grips with injector	Betaferon System	injection	broken syringe finger grips with injector	Low
broken syringe tip without injector	Betaferon System	injection	broken syringe tip without injector	Low
broken syringe tip with injector	Betaferon System	injection	broken syringe tip with injector	Low
difficulty depressing syringe plunger without injector	Betaferon System	injection	difficulty depressing syringe plunger without injector	Low
difficulty depressing syringe plunger with injector/ partial injection	Betaferon System	injection	difficulty depressing syringe plunger with injector	Low
difficulty removing needle shield without injector	Betaferon System	injection	difficulty removing needle shield without injector	Low
difficulty removing needle shield with injector	Betaferon System	injection	difficulty removing needle shield with injector	Low
leak - source unidentified	Betaferon System	injection	leak - source unidentified	Low
leak around the needle	Betaferon System	injection	leak around the needle	Low
leak between syringe and Mixject	Betaferon System	injection	leak between syringe and Mixject	Low
leak from Mixject valve	Betaferon System	injection	leak from Mixject valve	Low
needle hub issue	Betaferon System	injection	needle hub issue	Low
shattered syringe without injector	Betaferon System	injection	shattered syringe without injector	Low
shattered syringe with injector	Betaferon System	injection	shattered syringe with injector	Low

5.4.3 Specific: Betaject Lite, BetaConnect, Auto Injectors, MyBetaApp

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
usability issue	administration device	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
adverse reaction	administration device	medical event	adverse reaction	Low
unit not charging	administration device	malfunction	battery	Low
charging cord malfunction	administration device	malfunction	electrical problem	Low
broken syringe plunger rod with injector	syringe	damage	breakage	Low
broken syringe tip with injector	syringe	damage	breakage	Low

difficulty depressing syringe plunger with injector/ partial injection	syringe	handling issue	plunger mobility	Low
difficulty removing needle shield with injector	multi-component assembly	handling issue	handling difficult or impossible	Low
software - incompatible device operating system	software	compatibility - no software platforms	software	Low
software - injection data recording	software	injection data recording	record injections/ site	Low
software - device pairing problem	software	software communication	device pairing others	Low

5.5 Radiology (Contrast related excluding stand-alone devices)

Description **Document Reference**

US03REGS-BP000132

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
coring	rubber stopper	damage	breakage	Low
difficulty dispensing	bottle, phial, syringe	handling issue	**	Low
empty Bottle, Vial, Syringe	bottle, phial, syringe	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
foreign particles	solution	contamination/ foreign	particles	Medium
vial leakage	phial	damage	**	Low
syringe leakage	syringe	leakage	leakage/ not tightly closed	Low
loose dust cap or syringe cap	bottle, phial, syringe	damage	**	Low
low fill	bottle, phial, syringe	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
missing dust cap or syringe cap	bottle, phial, syringe	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
bottle, phial, syringe	bottle, phial, syringe	print/ labelling	label missing	Low
missing labelling	folding box	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
missing lot number/ expiration date	folding box, bottle, phial, syringe	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
missing stopper	rubber stopper	quantity	finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
missing bottle, phial, syringe	bottle, phial, syringe	quantity	final product missing in shipping container	Low
mixed lot	bottle, phial, syringe	other	mix up of batches/ product	Medium
product appearance	solution	appearance/ product characteristics	depends on complaint description	Low
product discoloration	solution	appearance/ product characteristics	discoloration	Medium
syringe tip blocked	syringe	damage	syringe tip blocked	Low

bottle, vial, syringe broke during use	bottle, phial, syringe	damage	breakage	Low
bottle, vial, syringe received broken	bottle, phial, syringe	damage	breakage	Low
suspected counterfeits	article	falsification	**	Medium
suspected diversion (smuggling or theft)	article	diversion	**	Low
suspected tampering	article	falsification	**	Medium
Adverse Event LODE	solution	medical event	adverse reaction no or reduced efficacy	**

5.6 Transcutaneous electrical nerve stimulation system (TENs)

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Level-1	IQMS error code Level-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Classification
AAA battery arrived dead	TENs device	damage	battery (AAA battery arrived dead)	Low
Battery contacts missing (e.g. spring/contact)	TENs device	damage	battery contacts missing	Low
damaged device fins	TENs device	damage	breakage (device fins)	Low
damaged device main body	TENs device	damage	breakage (device main body)	Low
damaged remote main body	TENs device	damage	breakage (remote main body)	Low
leaky/corroded AAA battery	TENs device	damage	battery (leaky/ corroded AAA battery)	Low
leaky/corroded remote battery	TENs device	damage	battery (leaky/ corroded remote battery)	Low
remote battery arrived dead	TENs device	damage	battery (remote battery arrived dead)	Low
battery panel removal issue	TENs device	handling issue	battery panel removal difficult or impossible	Low
communication error between remote and device	TENs device	malfunction	pairing error - device/ remote	Low
device has never worked	TENs device	malfunction	device has never worked	Low
device intensity is lower than before	TENs device	malfunction	device intensity is lower than before	Low
device intensity will not change	TENs device	malfunction	device intensity will not change	Low
device LED light flashing	TENs device	malfunction	device - LED light	Low
device making audible sound (buzz, humming etc.)	TENs device	malfunction	device making audible sound (buzz, humming etc.)	Low
device overheat	TENs device	malfunction	device overheat	Low

device stops working (beyond 1st day of use)	TENs device	malfunction	device stops working (beyond 1st day of use)	Low
device stops working (within 1st day of use)	TENs device	malfunction	device stops working (within 1st day of use)	Low
device will not power off	TENs device	malfunction	device will not power off	Low
increasing device intensity powers off device	TENs device	malfunction	increasing device intensity powers off device	Low
remote LED light flashing	TENs device	malfunction	remote - LED light	Low
remote has never worked	TENs device	malfunction	remote has never worked	Low
remote stops working (beyond 1st day of use)	TENs device	malfunction	remote stops working (beyond 1st day of use)	Low
remote stops working (within 1st day of use)	TENs device	malfunction	remote stops working (within 1st day of use)	Low
remote will not power off	TENs device	malfunction	remote will not power off	Low
short device battery life	TENs device	malfunction	short device battery life	Low
short remote battery life	TENs device	malfunction	short remote battery life	Low
stimulation duration longer than 30 minutes	TENs device	malfunction	stimulation duration longer than 30 minutes	Low
stimulation duration shorter than 30 minutes	TENs device	malfunction	stimulation duration shorter than 30 minutes	Low
stimulation only felt on one side	TENs device	malfunction	stimulation only felt on one side	Low
unexpected intensity changes	TENs device	malfunction	unexpected intensity changes	Low
allergic reaction	TENs device	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
bruise	TENs device	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
burn	TENs device	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
electrical event	TENs device	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
skin peel	TENs device	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
adverse reaction	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	not applicable
fire	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	Low
no or reduced efficacy	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	not applicable
off label use	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	not applicable
pain	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	not applicable
smoke	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	Medium

spark	TENs device	not applicable	not applicable	Medium
serial number missing on device	TENs device	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
serial number missing on remote	TENs device	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
gel pad discoloration on arrival	TENs gel pad	appearance/ product characteristics	gel pad discoloration	Low
lack of adhesion to back	TENs gel pad	appearance/ product characteristics	adhesion - does not adhere to skin	Low
lack of adhesion to device	TENs gel pad	appearance/ product characteristics	adhesion - does not adhere to skin	Low
too sticky, hard to get off, difficult to remove	TENs gel pad	appearance/ product characteristics	excess adhesion	Low
gel pad damaged on arrival (ripped, torn)	TENs gel pad	damage	gel pad perforation	Low
gel pad discoloration during use	TENs gel pad	damage	discoloration upon use	Low
gel pad melted before application to device	TENs gel pad	damage	melted prior to device application	Low
gel pad melted while device in use	TENs gel pad	damage	melted while in use	Medium
gel pad melted while device not in use	TENs gel pad	damage	melted while not in use	Low
shifted gel pad liner/cover	TENs gel pad	damage	shifted gel pad liner/cover	Low
handling difficulty (sticks to self, rolls up, ripped/torn)	TENs gel pad	handling issue	handling difficult/ impossible	Low
burn	TENs gel pad	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
electrical event	TENs gel pad	medical event	adverse reaction	Medium
missing lot number/ expired	TENs gel pad	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
smudged lot	TENs gel pad	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
missing gel pads	TENs gel pad	quantity	underfilling in immediate container	Low
missing gel pad liner/cover	TENs gel pad	quantity	Missing gel pad liner/ cover	Low
external packaging box damage	TENs folding box	damage	breakage, other, open, originality seal damaged, originality seal missing	Low
Internal contents (ripped/torn manual etc.)	TENs folding box	damage	perforation, breakage	Low
internal packaging components damage	TENs folding box	damage	concealed damage	Low
pouch packaging issue	TENs folding box	damage	breakage	Low
legibility	TENs folding box	print/ labelling	variable data illegible	Low
mismatching information	TENs folding box	print/ labelling	mismatching information	Low
missing information	TENs folding box	print/ labelling	variable data missing	Low
missing sticker	TENs folding box	print/ labelling	missing sticker	Low

missing batteries	TENs folding box	quantity	missing batteries	Low
missing device	TENs folding box	quantity	missing TENs device	Low
missing gel pad touch	TENs folding box	quantity	missing gel pad pouch	Low
missing paperwork (guides, manuals etc.)	TENs folding box	quantity	product insert	Low
missing remote	TENs folding box	quantity	missing remote	Low
missing screwdriver	TENs folding box	quantity	missing screwdriver	Low
potential manipulation (not previously resold)	article	falsification	manipulation	Medium
previously used/ resold	article	manipulation	used product put back on shelf for resale	Low

5.7 Midol Heat vibes

Product complaint reason	IQMS error code Leve-1	IQMS error code Leve-2	IQMS error code Level-3	Initial risk Category
Usability Issues				
Difficulty Removing Patch from Pouch	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Handling difficult or impossible	Low
Incorrect Storage Conditions	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Storage conditions	Low
Liner Difficult to Remove from Patch	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Removal difficulty	Low
Liner Dislodged When Patch Removed from Pouch	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Removal difficulty	Low
Microwaving Patch	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Patch microwaved	Low
Not Hot Enough	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Customer Satisfaction	Low
Patch Applied To Skin	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Patch applied to skin	Low
Product Ingestion	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Product ingested	Low
Re-Use of Product	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Product re-used	Low
Used with other products	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Used with other products	Low
Worn Incorrectly	Plaster/Patch	Handling issue	Worn incorrectly	Low
Product Technical complaints				
Commingling of Product	Pouch, Folding Box, Plaster/Patch	Other	Mix up of batches/Product	Medium
Cut Patch or Pouch	Plaster/Patch, Pouch	Damage	Other	Low
Discoloration	Plaster/Patch	Appearance/ Product Characteristics	Discoloration	Low
Does Not Heat Up	Plaster/Patch	Malfuction	Does not heat up	Low
Empty Carton	Folding Box	Quantity	Finished Package Incomplete (parts missing)	Low
Error of Imprint/Labeling Data	Label, Pouch, Folding Box	Print/Labelling	Error of Imprint/Labeling Data	Medium

Excess Adhesion	Plaster/Patch	Appearance/Product Characteristics	Excess Adhesion	Low
Excessive Heat	Plaster/Patch	Malfunction	Excessive Heat	Medium
Finished package incomplete	Plaster/Patch	Quantity	Finished package incomplete (parts missing)	Low
Foreign Substance in Packaging (no product contact)	Folding box	Contamination/Foreign matter	Depends on Description	Low
Foreign Substance in Product (product contact)	Plaster/Patch, Pouch	Contamination/Foreign Matter	Depends on Description	Medium
Heat Doesn't Last	Plaster/Patch	Malfunction	Heat doesn't last	Low
Imprint/ Labelling Information - Missing	Label, Pouch, Folding Box	Print/Labelling	Imprint/Labelling Data Missing	Low
Imprint/ Labelling Information - Illegible	Label, Pouch, Folding Box	Print/Labelling	Imprint/Labelling Data illegible	Low
Lack of Adhesion	Plaster/Patch	Appearance/Product Characteristics	Adhesion / Adhesiveness	Low
Leaking or Broken Patch	Plaster/Patch	Malfunction	Leakage/Breakage	Medium
Lot Number / Expiration Date - Illegible	Label, Pouch, Folding Box	Print/Labelling	Variable Data Illegible	Low
Lot Number / Expiration Date – Missing	Label, Pouch, Folding Box	Print/Labelling	Variable Data Missing	Low
Low fill (packaging not intact)	Pouch, Folding box	Quantity	Underfilling in Immediate Container	Low
Odor Complaint	Plaster/Patch, Pouch	Appearance/Product Characteristics	Odor	Low
Open Pouch	Pouch	Damage	Open	Low
Packaging received damaged (not attributed to shipping)	Folding box/Pouch	Damage	Immediate container	Low
Suspected Counterfeit	Article	Falsification	Depends on Description	Low
Suspected Diversion	Article	Diversion	Depends on description	Low
Suspected Tampering	Article	Falsification	Depends on description	Medium

6 Internal References

- GSOP 115 "Handling of Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents"
- Best Practice Nr. 1390 “Complaint risk classification for Oral Contraceptives or Hormone Replacement Therapy”
- SOP Radiology 202126
- US local Best Practice “Women’s Healthcare – Blistered Products Technical Complaint Guidance Document”
- US local Best Practice "HydraSense Technical Complaint Guidance Document”
- US local Best Practice "Plasters and Patches Technical Complaint Guidance Document”
- US local Best Practice "Transdermal Products (3M Drug Delivery Systems” Technical Complaint Guidance Document”
- US local Best Practice “Biologics Product Technical Complaint Guidance Document”
- US local Best Practice “Betaject Lite/ BetaConnect Auto Injectors/ MyBetaApp Technical Complaint Guidance Document”
- US local Best Practice “Radiological (Imaging) Products Technical Complaint Document”

7 Internal References

N/A

History of Changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
01	Not applicable	01.04.2020
02	# Change of Approvers acc. to SSC-SOP-003 v.4 # Complaints types related for eye drops added in chapter 5.2.4	22-02-2021
03	# Updated document number from SSC-BP-001 to SSC-PTC-BP-001 and references of the SSC-SOP-001 to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 # Updated SSC and SSCDN references to GBS # Updated distribution sheet or quality regulations # Updated Use Error definition according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 # Updated Risk Classification and error codes in section 5.5 Radiology (Contrast related excluding stand-alone devices)	23-10-2023
04	Removed obsolete references throughout the document. #Updated the definition of risk categorization to align with GSOP115. #Updated the definitions of counterfeit and falsification to align with GSOP115. #Replaced “Dev@Com” with “Complaint Database”. #Added Section 5.7, *Midol Heat Vibes*. #Replaced “Shared Service Center” with “Global Business Services”. #Removed Section 5.2.5, *Freeze-Away Product Line*. #Removed Section 5.4.2.5, *Medical Events Regarding the Betaseron System*. #Removed the MDR device problem code from Section 5.6.	See cover page

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Daniel Wang (daniel.wang2@bayer.com) Approver - Content 25-Aug-2026 08:24:35 GMT+0000
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